



Apollo 17 View of Earth

Apollo 17 was launched in December 1972. It was the final mission to the Moon and was the first manned launch made at night. The crew members were Harrison Schmitt, lunar module pilot; Ronald Evans, command module pilot; and Eugene Cernan, commander.

This photograph was taken when Apollo 17 was lined up with the Sun and the Earth, enabling the astronauts to take a full-disk view. Since it was December, the beginning of summer in the Southern Hemisphere, the icecap that covers the Antarctic continent was brightly illuminated. The land mass of Africa and southwestern Asia appears in the northwest quadrant.